

Levi O'Connor

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EDUCATION

B.A. in Psychology | University of Kansas | Expected Spring 2027

Cumulative GPA: 3.86

Certificates: Data Science; Mind and Brain Studies

Honors Thesis: In progress

Relevant Coursework

Men and Masculinities • Graduate Seminar in Cultural Psychology • Social Psychology • Research Methods • Intermediate Statistics • Philosophy of Psychology • Psychology and Social Issues

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Principal Student Investigator | Adams Lab | University of Kansas | May 2026 – Present

McNair Research Internship – *Supervisors:* Glenn Adams, Ph.D.; Syed Muhammad Omar, M.A.

Project: **Ontological Insecurity as a Predictor of Out-Group Cultural Use**

- Conducted literature review.
- Developed research questions.
- Created and collected survey instruments

Independent Research Project – *Supervisors:* Glenn Adams, Ph.D.; Syed Muhammad Omar, M.A.

Project: **Identity-Relevant Perceptions of Racism and Sexism**

- Conducted literature review.
- Assisted in the development of research questions.
- Collected survey instruments.
- Submitted materials to gain IRB approval.
- Designed a survey using Qualtrics.
- Published Survey to SONA.
- Published Survey to Cloud Connect Research.
- Analyzed data (linear regression, factor analyses, data visualization) using SPSS and R.
- Wrote the study into a manuscript.

Principal Student Investigator | Molina Lab | University of Kansas | Spring 2025 – Fall 2025

McNair Research Internship – *Supervisors:* Ludwin Molina, Ph.D.; Syed Muhammad Omar, M.A.

Project: **Perceived Threats of DEI: Demystifying White American Opposition**

- Conducted an extensive literature review.
- Developed an original research question and proposal.
- Developed an experimental design.
- Collected validated scales and new survey items.
- Submitted materials to gain IRB approval.

- Designed a survey using Qualtrics.
- Collected data utilizing Cloud Connect Research.
- Analyzed data (linear regression, factor analyses, data visualization) using SPSS and R.
- Wrote the study into a manuscript.

Research Assistant | Adams Lab | University of Kansas | Fall 2023 – Present
Adams Lab – *PI*: Glenn Adams, Ph.D.

Project: **Cultural Psychology of Environmentalism** | Fall 2024 – Spring 2025

- Reviewed state park documents and systematically coded the content.
- Maintained detailed records and an organized file system.

Project: **Happiness from Here: Conceptions of Experience of Well-Being in Ghana** | Fall 2023 – Spring 2024

- Extensive literature review
- Conducted linear regressions in SPSS.

PRESENTATIONS

Poster Presentations

O'Connor, L., Omar, S. M., & Adams, G. (2026, April). *Identity-Relevant Perceptions of Racism and Sexism*. Presented at the Symposium for Undergraduate Psychology Engagement and Research, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

O'Connor, L., Omar, S. M., & Adams, G. (2026, April). *Identity-Relevant Perceptions of Racism and Sexism*. Presented at the University of Kansas Undergraduate Research Symposium, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

O'Connor, L., Omar, S. M., & Adams, G. (2026, April). *Identity-Relevant Perceptions of Racism and Sexism*. Presented at the Student Research Conference in the Psychological Sciences, Kansas City Kansas Community College, Kansas City, KS.

O'Connor, L., Omar, S. M., & Molina, L. (2026, February). *Perceived Threats of DEI: Demystifying White American Opposition*. Presented at SPSP 2026 Conference, Chicago, IL.

O'Connor, L., Omar, S. M., Lies, T., & Adams, G. (2024, May). *Cultural Psychology of Environmentalism*. Presented at the Emerging Scholars Undergraduate Research Symposium Poster Session, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

Oral Presentations

O'Connor, L., Omar, S. M., & Adams, G. (2026, March). *Identity-Relevant Perceptions of Racism and Sexism*. Presented at the Hall Center Undergraduate Research Colloquium, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

O'Connor, L., Omar, S. M., & Molina, L. (2025, September). *Perceived Threats of DEI: Demystifying White American Opposition*. Presented at MKN Heartland Conference, Kansas City, MO.

O'Connor, L., Omar, S. M., & Molina, L. (2025, July). *Perceived Threats of DEI: Demystifying White American Opposition*. Presented at McNair Scholars Research Symposium, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

Invited Talks

O'Connor, L. (2026, June). *How to Make a Research Poster Peer Panel*. McNair Scholars Professional Development, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

O'Connor, L. (2026, April). *Student Address*. McNair Scholars Program End of the Year Banquet, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

O'Connor, L. (2025, June). *College Student Panel*. Panelist at TRIO Talent Search, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

HONORS AND AWARDS

Research and Academic Awards

Beinecke Scholarship Program (Spring 2026) – \$35,000 | *Awarded by the Sperry Fund*

- The Sperry Fund offers 16 students of exceptional promise \$35,000 to be used for graduate study in the social sciences and humanities.

Best Independent Project Honorable Mention (Spring 2026) | *Awarded by University of Kansas Department of Psychology*

Best Poster (Spring 2026) | *Awarded by Kansas City Community College Psychology Conference*

Diversity Undergraduate Registration Stipend (Spring 2026) - \$217 | *Awarded by the Society for Personality and Social Psychology*

University of Kansas Travel Award (Spring 2026) – \$500 | *Awarded by University of Kansas Center for Undergraduate Research and Fellowships*

- Awarded to students who are presenting their research or creative projects at an academic conference.

Undergraduate Research Award (Fall 2026; Spring 2026; Fall 2025) – \$1,000 each | *Awarded by University of Kansas Center for Undergraduate Research and Fellowships*

- Awarded for original, substantive, independent research projects.

Scholarships

Jerry Bailey Educational Opportunity Scholarship (Spring 2025) – \$1,750 | *Awarded by University of Kansas Center for Educational Opportunity Programs*

- For low-income, first-generation students demonstrating academic success despite challenges.

Kansas Education Opportunity Scholarship (Fall 2023) – \$7,400 | *Awarded by Kansas Board of Regents*

- Need and merit-based award for academic proficiency and financial need.

University of Kansas Chancellor's Scholarship (Fall 2023) – \$20,000 | *Awarded by University of Kansas Office of Admissions*

- Awarded for a 4.0 high school GPA.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Program Coordinator | University Career Center | University of Kansas | Spring 2025 – Present

- Managing a program budget of \$240,000, ensuring accurate allocation and tracking of funds.
- Overseeing daily operations of the work study program, supporting over 50 clients.
- Performing clerical tasks: file management, scheduling, correspondence, and data entry.
- Communicate regularly with clients via email to provide scheduling updates, deadline reminders, and policy information.

Peer Mentor | Center for Undergraduate Research | University of Kansas | Fall 2024 – Spring 2025

- Presented at monthly professional development and research preparation sessions.
- Created lesson plans for each meeting to ensure engagement and facilitate a positive learning environment.
- Hosted individual meetings with seven students to track mentees' progress in research and aid in anything they might need academically.

ORGANIZATIONS

Competitive Programs and Fellowships

Beinecke Scholarship Program | Spring 2026 – Present | Role: Member

- The Beinecke Scholarship Program supports students of exceptional promise seeking to attend graduate school programs in the arts, humanities, or social sciences. Up to 16 scholarships are awarded each year.

Hall Center Undergraduate Fellow | Fall 2025 – Spring 2026 | Role: Fellow

- The Hall Center for the Humanities is one of 11 research centers on KU's campus. The Hall Center's mission is to promote and support "humanistic inquiry": scholarly and creative productions that help us understand who we are as people, how we relate to others, and what has led our global society to where we are today.

Ronald E. McNair Scholar | Center for Educational Opportunity | University of Kansas | Spring 2025 – Present | Role: Member

- The mission of the KU TRIO McNair Scholars Program is to amplify excellence and advance academic and research fields by preparing students for Ph.D. programs.

Emerging Scholar | Center for Undergraduate Research | University of Kansas | Fall 2023 – Spring 2025 | Role: Member; Peer Mentor

- The Emerging Scholars Program provides research experiences for low-income students in their first year at KU and supports their overall transition to college.

Professional Memberships

Kansas Research Collective | Spring 2026 – Present | Role: Co-Founder

- Created a student-led transdisciplinary research group in partnership with the University of Kansas Center for Undergraduate Research and Fellowships.

Rising Scholars Program | Spring 2026 – Present | Role: Member

- The University of Kansas Rising Scholars are students in their 3rd to 5th semester who have demonstrated academic achievement and exhibit promise as candidates for competitive national fellowships and scholarships.

Tri-Alpha | Fall 2025 – Present | Role: Member

- National honor society which recognizes and celebrates the achievements of first-generation students across the United States.

Society for Personality and Social Psychology | Fall 2025 – Present | Role: Student Member

- The Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) is an academic society for personality and social psychologists focused on promoting scientific research that explores how people think, behave and interact. It is the largest organization of social psychologists and personality psychologists in the world.

Psi Chi | Department of Psychology | University of Kansas | Spring 2025 – Present | Role: Secretary; Member

- Psi Chi is an international organization of professionals, scientists, faculty, students, and alumni whose mission is to recognize and promote excellence in the science and application of psychology.

Cultural Psychology Research Group | University of Kansas | Fall 2023 – Present | Role: Member

- The Cultural Psychology Research Group is a community of scholars and researchers who are broadly interested in the idea of “mind in context.”

CERTIFICATES AND TRAININGS

CITI Program: Responsible Conduct of Research (RCR) (Completed March 2025)

FERPA: Student Records and Privacy Compliance – University of Kansas (Completed May 2025)

CITI Program: Social & Behavioral Research – Basic/Refresher (Completed September 2023)

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

SPSS: Intermediate

R: Intermediate

Qualtrics: Intermediate

Python: Beginner

NON-ACADEMIC PURSUITS

University of Kansas E-Sports | Counter-Strike Team | University of Kansas | Fall 2023 – Present | Role: Team Captain

- Organize matches and maintain a weekly match schedule
- Play weekly to ensure high-individual level
- Top 1,000 ranked individual player nationally (roughly top 0.2% of the national player base)
- Multiple high-ranking finishes in collegiate tournaments
- Prize winnings to-date: \$1,200.00